



Institute for Community Inclusion at UMass Boston, with support
from the Massachusetts Department of Developmental Services



CBDS Fundamentals Lunch & Learn

February 27, 2025

Agenda:

- Defining Community-Based Day Supports
- CBDS: What it IS and What it is NOT
- Person-Centered Planning
- CBDS as a Pathway to Employment
- Community Mapping
- Building Strong CBDS Services
- Resources



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Let's hear from you!

- What is your professional role
- How long have you worked in CBDS



CBDS Defined

“This program of supports is designed to enable an individual to enrich his or her life and enjoy a full range of community activities by providing opportunities for developing, enhancing, and maintaining competency in personal, social and community activities” (MA DDS)

- Career Exploration
- Volunteering
- Skills Training and Development
- Socialization
- Pursuit of Personal Hobbies and Interests



Who is CBDS for?

Working-
age Adults

Employed
Part-time

Retirement-
age



CBDS IS

- Person-Centered
- Purposeful
- Pathway
- Opportunity
- Community Based

CBDS is NOT

- Random
- Activities to fill the day
- Replacement for paid employment
- Pre-requisite for employment
- One-size fits all



Person-Centered Practice and CBDS

“The design of a CBDS service, the types of activities it facilitates, and the way individuals spend their time within CBDS should be based first and foremost on a thoughtful, person-centered planning process, that identifies an individual’s preferences and interests.”

Key values:

- Choice
- Dignity
- Respect
- Strength-based
- Whole person



Person-Centered Thinking

Important
TO

Important
FOR



Quick Poll: How do we know what is important to people?



Getting to know you, getting to know all about you...

Tips for Person-Centered Planning

- Use a variety of methods/tools
 - Consider learning styles/needs
- Cast a wide net
- Experiential learning
 - Expanding horizons
- Welcome feedback
 - Read between the lines
- Capture information, update regularly, respect change and growth



Resource Spotlight: Charting the LifeCourse

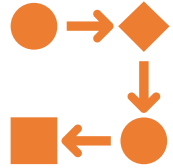


CBDS as a Pathway to Employment

- Belief: All individuals of working age should have the opportunity to work in the community
- Employment goal vs non-employment goal
- How:
 - Discover and explore
 - Practice and experience
 - Develop preferences and interests
 - Build relevant skills



Pathway to Employment



Approach:

How are you learning about the folks you are supporting?

Moving beyond “Do you want to work”

Tools to dig deeper



Team:

Individual in drivers seat

Role of Staff

Case Manager

Family/Caregiver



Maximize time in the community:

Identifying community based opportunities

Purposeful Connections



Employment-Driven CBDS Activities

Career Exploration

- Volunteering
- Workplace Tours
- Job shadowing
- Situational assessments
- Internships
- Informational interviews
- Job clubs



Skill Building through participation in CBDS activities



Travel Training

Health and wellness

Employment skill development

Vocational training and certifications

Classes/workshops

Managing public benefits



Community Mapping

Process for exploring and identifying various resources or assets available within a defined community

- Community – which one?
- CBDS Core Principles:
 - Purposeful
 - Person-centered
 - Maximize time in the community
 - Pathways to employment and community engagement
 - Inclusive
 - Adult appropriate
 - Relationship Development



Factors to Consider



Who is Mapping?

What are we Mapping?

What do we do with this information?

How do we gather the information?



Building Strong CBDS Programs





Mindset Matters!

Core Values and Principles Driving Successful CBDS:

- Community Life Engagement
- Dignity and Risk
- Person-Centered
- Self-determination
- Informed Choice

Resources

- Ensuring Excellence in Community-Based Day Supports: A Guide for Service Providers and Staff
 - [DDS CBDS web F.pdf \(employmentfirstma.org\)](#)
- Employment First Massachusetts
 - [Employment First Massachusetts](#)
- Community Life Engagement
 - [Community Life Engagement Toolkit | Think Work](#)
- Charting the LifeCourse
 - <https://www.lifecoursetools.com/>
- LifeCourse in Action webinar series
 - [Register for Series](#)





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